

F5 Daily Briefing - Thursday, May 21, 2026

Daily competitive intelligence covering 22 F5 competitors

22

COMPETITORS TRACKED

23

ANNOUNCEMENTS

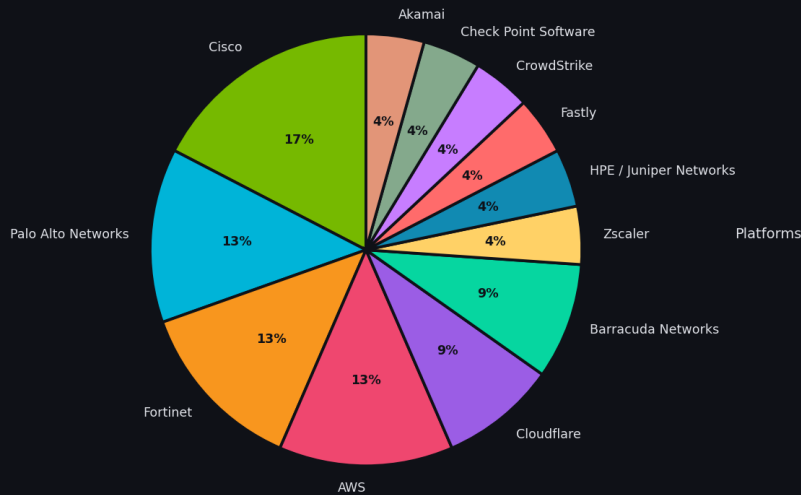
12

ACTIVE

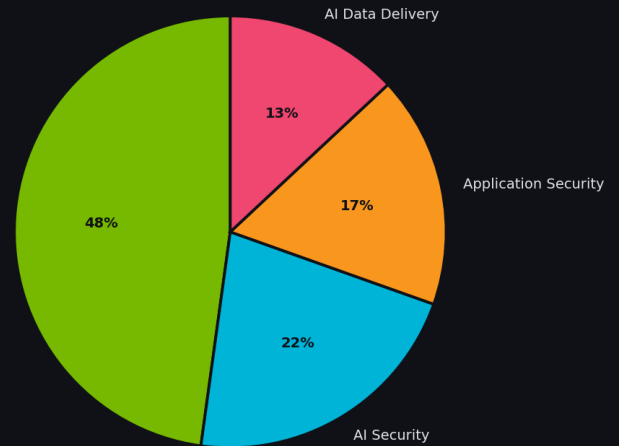
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ACTIVE CATEGORIES

Announcements by Competitor



Announcements by Category



ALL ANNOUNCEMENTS (23)

ACQUISITION

ZSCALER

2026-05-21

Zscaler Announces Intent to Acquire Symmetry Systems to Map and Secure AI Agent Communication

On May 21, 2026, Zscaler announced its intent to acquire Symmetry Systems. The deal combines Symmetry's access graph technology - mapping how human and non-human identities, applications, and data connect across the enterprise - with Zscaler's Zero Trust Exchange. The goal is to govern AI agent communication at scale, providing foundational visibility for policy enforcement and dynamic responses to risky agent-to-application and agent-to-agent activity. Symmetry ingests logs from SaaS, public clouds, data stores, and AI systems. Closing is expected in fiscal Q4 2026, subject to customary conditions.

Source: <https://www.zscaler.com/press/ai-announcement>

PRESS RELEASE

PALO ALTO NETWORKS

2026-05-21

Palo Alto Networks Execs: Platformization Is The Key In Frontier AI Shift

At Ignite on Tour in New York on May 21, 2026, Palo Alto Networks executives emphasized that platformization is essential to combat AI-driven frontier threats. Leaders highlighted moving beyond point tools toward a unified, tightly integrated security platform that can match the speed and scale of AI-enabled exploits. They cited the new Idira identity brand (built on CyberArk), use of frontier AI models internally to scan code (resulting in 26 disclosed CVEs), and partner/service-provider collaboration as proof points. The company estimates a 3-5 month window before AI-driven exploits go mainstream.

Source: <https://www.cm.com/news/security/2026/palo-alto-networks-execs-platformization-is-the-key-in-frontier-ai-shift>

OTHER

PALO ALTO NETWORKS

2026-05-21

Customers Show Confidence in Palo Alto Networks AI Security Strategy at Ignite On Tour, Jefferies Says

Jefferies analysts attending PANW Ignite On Tour in NYC on May 21, 2026 reported strong customer interest in the AI security strategy, including recent Portkey (AI gateway) and Koi Security (MCP/browser extension governance) acquisitions, with closes expected in fiscal Q4 2026 and H2 2026. Customers largely accepted a 10% firewall price increase. Cortex Cloud has reached feature parity with Prisma Cloud, accelerating migration. Over 500 North American customers requested Mythos briefings and 170+ asked for Unit 42 assessments; a May patch advisory addressed 26 CVEs.

Source: <https://www.proactiveinvestors.com/companies/news/1092721/palo-alto-networks-customers-show-confidence-in-ai-security-strategy-at-ignite-on-tour-event-jefferies-says-1092721.html>

PRODUCT LAUNCH

PALO ALTO NETWORKS

2026-05-21

Securing Enterprise AI Adoption: Palo Alto Networks Integrates with the Claude Compliance API

Palo Alto Networks announced on May 21, 2026 an integration with Anthropic's Claude Compliance API to enable safer enterprise use of Claude. Built on Cortex Cloud Data Security Posture Management (DSPM), the integration provides programmatic visibility into how sensitive data flows through Claude Enterprise, plus data protection, governance, threat detection, and policy enforcement against violations and anomalous behavior. The capability allows organizations to share data with Claude more securely while preserving compliance and risk posture, addressing a foundational governance gap for enterprise generative AI usage.

Source: <https://www.paloaltonetworks.com/blog/cloud-security/claude-security-integration-ai-governance/>

PARTNERSHIP

HPE / JUNIPER NETWORKS

2026-05-21

HPE Unifies Global Distribution With Ingram Micro and TD SYNnex

HPE named Ingram Micro and TD SYNnex as its two global distribution partners under a unified distribution strategy following the Juniper Networks acquisition. The move standardizes partner enablement, operations, and services across HPE's combined portfolio (compute, storage, GreenLake, and Juniper networking). Rollout will include country-level adjustments to respect regional needs while preserving global consistency, with HPE engaging partners throughout the transition. Juniper's existing distributor network will be retained alongside the two primary global distributors, creating a more consolidated channel landscape for HPE's post-Juniper platform play.

Source: <https://lifestyle.capitalcityrock.com/story/228113/hpe-unifies-global-distribution-with-ingram-micro-and-td-synnex/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH

FORTINET

2026-05-21

Fortinet Introduces FortiOS 8.0 with Secure AI Controls, Fabric-Based AI Agents, Flexible SASE, and Simplified SD-WAN

At Fortinet Accelerate 2026 on May 21, 2026, Fortinet unveiled FortiOS 8.0, the next-generation Security Fabric operating system. The release expands Secure Networking with three core innovation areas: AI-driven security, next-gen SASE, and quantum-safe capabilities. It promises deeper visibility, stronger control, and future-ready protection across network edge, cloud, and data center, while simplifying architectures and reducing complexity. Designed to support enterprises adopting GenAI, hybrid work, and cloud-first strategies, the OS underpins fabric-based AI agents and flexible SASE delivery.

Source: <https://www.fortinet.com/corporate/about-us/newsroom/press-releases/2026/fortinet-introduces-fortios-8-expand-secure-networking-with-secure-ai-controls-fabric-based-ai-agents-flexible-sase-and-simplified-sdwan>

RESEARCH

FORTINET

2026-05-21

AI-Driven Cyber Threats Outpace Defences as Firms Struggle with Security Complexity - Fortinet

In a May 21, 2026 release, Fortinet highlighted findings from a Forrester Consulting study of 585 cybersecurity decision-makers across Asia-Pacific showing that AI-driven threats and security complexity are outpacing defenses. Fortinet warns that fragmented tools and limited visibility hinder AI security effectiveness. APAC leadership emphasized the need for integrated platforms unifying automation, visibility, and AI-driven intelligence to improve detection and response, arguing that AI will only deliver meaningful security outcomes when built on a fully integrated, unified foundation.

Source: <https://www.thevibes.com/articles/lifestyles/123212/ai-driven-cyber-threats-outpace-defences-as-firms-struggle-with-security-complexity-fortinet>

SECURITY ADVISORY

FORTINET

2026-05-21

Critical Fortinet Patches: FortiAuthenticator and FortiSandbox Flaws (CVE-2026-44277, CVE-2026-26083)

On May 21, 2026, Fortinet disclosed two critical (CVSS 9.1) vulnerabilities. CVE-2026-44277 affects FortiAuthenticator via an improper access control flaw allowing unauthenticated code execution; fixed in 6.5.7, 6.6.9, and 8.0.3. CVE-2026-26083 affects FortiSandbox, FortiSandbox Cloud, and FortiSandbox PaaS through a missing authorization issue in the web UI permitting unauthenticated RCE; fixed in 4.4.9, 5.0.2, and Cloud 5.0.6. Coverage placed these at the top of priority patching due to unauthenticated attack paths.

Source: <https://menacyberwire.com/post/ivanti-fortinet-sap-vmware-and-n8n-release-critical-security-patches-may-2026>

PRODUCT LAUNCH

FASTLY

2026-05-21

Fastly Unveils DDoS Attack Insights to Strengthen Protection and Security Transparency

Fastly announced Attack Insights, a new capability added to Fastly DDoS Protection that gives security teams real-time visibility into in-progress DDoS events. Attack Insights surfaces live attack behavior and mitigation status so teams can validate that defenses are working as attacks unfold, improving transparency and cross-team collaboration during incident response. The feature is available to existing Fastly DDoS Protection customers and can be added directly through the Fastly control panel, extending protection for applications and APIs.

Source: <https://www.fastly.com/press/press-releases/fastly-unveils-ddos-attack-insights-to-strengthen-protection-and-security-transparency>

PRODUCT LAUNCH

CROWDSTRIKE

2026-05-21

CrowdStrike Delivers Visibility and Monitoring for Claude Activity via Claude's Compliance API

On May 21, 2026, CrowdStrike announced an integration with Anthropic's Claude Compliance API that brings Claude Enterprise and Claude Platform activity into the Falcon platform. Activity logs and conversation content stream into Falcon Next-Gen SIEM and Charlotte Agentic SOAR, enabling centralized visibility, detection, response, and governance for enterprise AI usage. Security teams can correlate Claude activity with endpoint, identity, and cloud telemetry, automate response via SOAR workflows, and enforce policy through Falcon AI Detection and Response (AIDR) and Falcon Shield, unifying AI activity within the CrowdStrike Security Cloud.

Source: <https://www.crowdstrike.com/en-us/press-releases/crowdstrike-delivers-visibility-and-monitoring-for-claude-activity/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**CLOUDFLARE**

2026-05-21

Cloudflare CASB Adds Claude Compliance API Support for AI Governance

Cloudflare announced that its CASB now supports Anthropic's Claude Compliance API, letting Cloudflare One customers monitor Claude Enterprise usage and surface security/compliance findings without inline traffic inspection or endpoint agents. The integration surfaces violations across projects, attachments, chats, and artifacts, organizes findings by category and severity, and supports Claude Platform events such as API key creation and file downloads. Findings can be triaged alongside Microsoft 365, Google Workspace, and Salesforce, and converted into Cloudflare Gateway policies to block uploads, restrict access, or limit functionality. Setup uses Zero Trust > Integrations > Cloud & SaaS with optional DLP profiling.

Source: <https://blog.cloudflare.com/casb-anthropic-integration/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**CLOUDFLARE**

2026-05-21

Cloudflare Launches AI Gateway REST API for Unified Multi-Provider Model Routing

Cloudflare announced a new AI Gateway REST API that lets developers call any model - OpenAI, Anthropic, Google, or Workers AI - through a single unified API on api.cloudflare.com. Four endpoints are available: a universal `/ai/run`, OpenAI-compatible `/ai/v1/chat/completions` and `/ai/v1/responses`, and Anthropic-compatible `/ai/v1/messages`. All AI Gateway features - logging, caching, rate limiting, and guardrails - are applied automatically, and third-party model requests are billed via Unified Billing with no separate provider keys needed. Requests route through a default gateway, or a specific one via the `cf-aig-gateway-id` header, consolidating multi-provider AI traffic management for enterprises.

Source: <https://developers.cloudflare.com/changelog/post/2026-05-21-rest-api/>

PARTNERSHIP**CISCO**

2026-05-21

Cisco Partners With College Board to Launch AP Cybersecurity

On May 21, 2026, Cisco NetAcad announced a partnership with the College Board to launch AP Cybersecurity as part of AP Career Kickstart courses beginning in the 2026-2027 school year. Cisco Networking Academy provides industry-aligned curriculum, hands-on labs, and educator support. The 2025-2026 pilot reached 3,100 students across 183 schools in 30 states; about 500 educators registered for AP Summer Institutes ahead of national rollout. The initiative aims to address the cybersecurity talent shortfall by creating clear academic pathways into security careers.

Source: <https://blogs.cisco.com/learning/cisco-partners-with-college-board-to-launch-ap-cybersecurity>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**CISCO**

2026-05-21

Cisco Unveils Universal Quantum Switch for Scalable Networks

On May 21, 2026, Cisco unveiled a research prototype called the Universal Quantum Switch designed to connect disparate quantum systems by translating between major encoding modalities (polarization, time-bin, frequency-bin) without destroying quantum information. It operates at room temperature on existing telecom fiber using a Cisco-patented conversion engine to route quantum signals across modalities and vendors. Polarization routing is demonstrated; time-bin and frequency-bin support is integrated and undergoing validation. Cisco positions this as a pivotal step toward scalable, multi-vendor quantum networks and the future quantum internet.

Source: <https://gecnewswire.com/cisco-unveils-universal-quantum-switch-for-scalable-networks/>

SECURITY ADVISORY**CISCO**

2026-05-21

Max Severity Cisco Secure Workload Flaw Gives Site Admin Privileges (CVE-2026-20223)

On May 21, 2026, Cisco disclosed a critical CVSS 10.0 vulnerability in Secure Workload (CVE-2026-20223). Insufficient validation and authentication in internal REST APIs let unauthenticated attackers gain Site Admin privileges, allowing them to read sensitive data and alter configurations across tenant boundaries. There are no workarounds. Fixes are available in Secure Workload 3.10.8.3 and 4.0.3.17; SaaS deployments have been patched, and customers on 3.9 or earlier should migrate. PSIRT reported no known exploitation in the wild at disclosure.

Source: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/cisco-max-severity-secure-workload-flaw-gives-hackers-site-admin-privileges/>

OTHER**CISCO**

2026-05-21

Cisco's New Certs Are a Wake-Up Call for AI-Era Network Engineers

On May 21, 2026, Cisco signaled a major shift in its certification strategy for AI-era networking. Updated CCNA and CCIE programs reflect AI-first needs, embedding AI, automation, observability, and human skills into the learning path. New CCNA exam topics released May 20, 2026; the refreshed CCNA goes live February 3, 2027, and an AI-focused CCIE Data Center module is planned for 2027 with phased blueprint and lab releases at Cisco Live events. Cisco aims to align certifications with evolving roles combining AI tooling and human judgment.

Source: <https://www.networkworld.com/article/4175910/ciscos-new-certs-are-a-wake-up-call-for-ai-era-network-engineers.html>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**CHECK POINT SOFTWARE**

2026-05-21

Check Point Launches Agentic Network Security Orchestration Platform; Acquires Deepchecks Team & IP

Check Point announced its Agentic Network Security Orchestration Platform, an autonomous agent-based architecture that executes enterprise network security operations with minimal human intervention. The platform shifts from static rules to intent-based policy, dynamic exposure-based controls, and a unified orchestration layer grounded in a Network Knowledge Graph. Policy Auditor, Policy Insights, and AI Assist are available now; Playblocks Agents are in Early Availability with broader multi-vendor support planned for H2 2026. Check Point also disclosed the acquisition of Deepchecks' team and IP to accelerate AI evaluation, observability, testing, and monitoring of agentic workflows.

Source: <https://it-online.co.za/2026/05/21/check-point-announces-agentic-network-security-orchestration-platform-replacing-years-of-rule-based-complexity/>

RESEARCH**BARRACUDA NETWORKS**

2026-05-21

AI-Powered Phishing Puts MSSPs on the Defensive: Barracuda

Barracuda Networks warns that AI-powered, phishing-as-a-service (PhaaS) campaigns are accelerating attacks against MSSPs and their clients. Per Barracuda telemetry cited in its 2026 Email Threats Report, 90% of high-volume phishing campaigns leveraged PhaaS kits, and phishing accounts for roughly 48% of malicious email activity. PhaaS bundles templates, fake login pages, hosting, automation, and analytics - lowering attacker skill barriers and enabling real-time MFA interception. Barracuda urges MSSPs to move beyond email filtering to behavior-based detection (unusual logins, suspicious mailbox rules) and rapid cross-client incident response.

Source: <https://www.msspalert.com/news/ai-makes-phishing-easier-for-bad-actors-more-difficult-for-mssps-barracuda>

OTHER

BARRACUDA NETWORKS

2026-05-21

Bailey AI Assistant Release (2026.05.21) for BarracudaONE

Barracuda released a May 21, 2026 update to its Bailey AI Assistant for the BarracudaONE platform. The release clarifies Entra ID references by specifying which Barracuda product the Entra ID information applies to, resolving issue ID 4616. The fix improves accuracy and reduces ambiguity for partners and admins querying identity-related guidance through the in-product AI assistant.

Source: <https://documentation.campus.barracuda.com/wiki/spaces/ONE/pages/556466351/Release+notes+-+Bailey+AI+Assistant+2026.05.21>

RESEARCH

AKAMAI

2026-05-21

Decentralized Threat: Stealthy P2P Cryptominer Targeting Ollama Endpoints

Akamai security research published a deep-dive on a Go-based P2P cryptominer/RAT backdoor (dubbed "vc") targeting exposed Ollama LLM endpoints. The malware uses a custom libp2p decentralized mesh (WebRTC, QUIC, DTLS, UPnP) to evade traditional IP/domain C2 blocks, masquerades as a kworker process, and persists via root crontab every 15 minutes. The post details a seven-step execution chain, RAM-disk persistence techniques, IOCs, and mitigations including blocking outbound QUIC, auditing crontab entries, and isolating compromised AI inference hosts. It highlights evolving supply-chain risk for AI/LLM environments.

Source: <https://www.akamai.com/blog/security-research/stealthy-p2p-cryptominer-ollama-endpoints>

PRESS RELEASE

AWS

2026-05-21

AWS KY3P Report Now Available for Third-Party Supplier Due Diligence

AWS announced completion of its 2026 S&P Global KY3P (Know Your Third Party) security assessment, with the validated report now available to customers for third-party supplier due diligence. The evidence-based evaluation covers more than 200 AWS security controls across 26 categories and nine risk domains, and maps to frameworks including NIST CSF v2, PCI DSS 4.0, and ISO 27001:2022. The KY3P report is intended to reduce due-diligence burden for customers in regulated industries - particularly financial services - when evaluating AWS as a cloud provider. Access details are on the AWS KY3P assessment page.

Source: <https://aws.amazon.com/blogs/security/aws-ky3p-report-now-available-for-third-party-supplier-due-diligence/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH

AWS

2026-05-21

Amazon Nova Act Is Now HIPAA Eligible for Healthcare AI Agents

AWS announced that Amazon Nova Act, its service for building and managing fleets of autonomous, browser-based AI agents, is now HIPAA eligible. Healthcare and life sciences organizations can deploy agents to automate complex workflows involving ePHI - appointment scheduling, insurance verification, prior authorizations, claims, and referrals - under HIPAA compliance. Nova Act integrates with Strands Agents, Amazon Bedrock AgentCore, CloudWatch, and IAM, supports external tools via APIs and MCP, and escalates to human supervisors when needed. Initially available in US East (N. Virginia). Customers retain HIPAA control responsibilities under the AWS Shared Responsibility Model.

Source: <https://aws.amazon.com/blogs/machine-learning/amazon-nova-act-is-now-hipaa-eligible/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH

AWS

2026-05-21

AWS Adds OpenAI-Compatible API Support to Amazon SageMaker AI Endpoints

AWS announced OpenAI-compatible API support for Amazon SageMaker AI endpoints, enabling developers to invoke SageMaker-hosted models using OpenAI-style API calls. The change broadens interoperability between SageMaker and the wide ecosystem of OpenAI-compatible tooling, SDKs, and applications, easing migration and integration for teams already standardized on OpenAI APIs. It positions SageMaker as a drop-in inference backend for OpenAI-compatible clients, strengthening AWS's AI model serving and inference delivery story against rival AI gateway and model-routing offerings.

Source: <https://au.marketscreener.com/news/aws-says-announcing-openai-compatible-api-support-for-amazon-sagemaker-ai-endpoints-ce7f5ad9d189f426>